

qmtk Soccer

Quality Minds. Technical Knowledge.

Train Smart. Play Smart.

Coaching Playbook

Editable Edition · with field diagrams

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Compiled May 2026 · Coach Shaya

How to use this playbook

This is the live editable version of the qmtk Coaching Playbook. Edit anything inline — drill names, coaching points, weekly themes, sample sessions. When you want to add new drills or games, ask Claude and the playbook will be updated.

Three layers, used together:

- Weekly Skill Plan tells you the theme of the week.
- Session Plan Template is what you fill out for each Mon/Fri.
- Drill Library is what you pull from to fill the three station slots.

Sample sessions show what a fully prefilled plan looks like — use them as a reference the first few weeks, then build your own.

Contents

Section	What it is
1. Session Plan Template — K–5	Blank shell for a 60-min K–5 session
2. Sample Session — K–5 (Week 1)	Fully prefilled K–5 session
3. Session Plan Template — Grades 6–8	Blank shell for middle school
4. Sample Session — Grades 6–8 (Week 1)	Fully prefilled middle-school session
5. Drill Library — 18 core drills + 8 weekly fresh games	Standardized cards with field diagrams
6. Weekly Skill Plan — K–5 (8 weeks)	Season curriculum + featured fresh game per week
7. Weekly Skill Plan — Grades 6–8 (8 weeks)	Season curriculum, tactical progression

1 · Session Plan Template — K–5 (Elementary)

Fill this out for any K–5 session. Use the Sample Session below as a reference for what 'filled out' looks like.

Session info

Date	_____
Location	_____
Coach(es)	_____
Group / # players	K–5 — # players: _____ — Focus: _____
Equipment	Cones (____), pinnies (____), balls (____), goals (____), other: ____
Theme	_____

Schedule (60 min total)

Time	Block	Drill / Activity
0–10	Warm-up game	_____
10–13	Water break	Hydrate + reset
13–23	Station A	_____
23–33	Station B	_____
33–43	Station C	_____
43–45	Water break	Final reset before scrimmage
45–60	Scrimmage	_____

Coach notes (fill after session)

What worked

What to adjust next time

Players to watch / call out (+)

Parent-facing summary

2 · Sample Session — K–5 (Week 1: Ball Mastery)

Fully prefilled example. Use as a reference or copy as-is.

Date	Monday, May 11, 2026 · 5:50–6:50 PM
Location	Sanborn Elementary — Lower Field, Andover
Coach(es)	Coach Shaya (lead), assistant TBD
Group / # players	K–5 — # players: ~16 (split K–1 from 2–5 if 6+ K-1s)
Equipment	20 cones, 8 pinnies (2 colors), 16 balls, 2 pop-up goals, whistle
Theme	Ball mastery & comfort — hundreds of touches, joy, no pressure

Schedule (60 min)

Time	Block	Drill
0–10	Warm-up	Sharks & Minnows (split K–1 from 2–5)
10–13	Water	—
13–23	Station A	Pirates (Steal the Treasure) — fresh game of the week
23–33	Station B	Partner Passing — 2-Touch Rule
33–43	Station C	Red Light, Green Light (with a ball)
43–45	Water	—
45–60	Scrimmage	3v3 / 4v4 small-sided, split by age, no keepers, free play

Coach notes (sample, prefilled)

What worked	Pirates was the runaway hit — even the shy K–1s were fully bought in. The 2-touch rule clicked once we slowed the pace down.
What to adjust	Sharks & Minnows grid was too big for K–1 — shrink to 12x12 next time. Tighter station rotations on the whistle.
Players to watch (+)	Liam (K) — first session, needed help but stayed engaged the whole hour. Maya (3rd) — natural leader, called teammates forward in the scrimmage.
Parent summary	This week we focused on ball mastery — your player got hundreds of touches through Pirates, Sharks & Minnows, and partner passing. Next week we move to first-touch control.

3 · Session Plan Template — Grades 6–8 (Middle School)

Same shell, faster pace, tactical layer added.

Session info

Date	_____
Location	_____
Coach(es)	_____
Group / # players	6–8 — # players: _____ — Focus: _____
Equipment	Cones (____), pinnies in 3 colors (____), balls (____), goals + GKs (____), other: ____
Theme	_____

Schedule (60 min total)

Time	Block	Drill / Activity
0–10	Warm-up game	_____
10–13	Water break	Hydrate + reset
13–23	Station A	_____
23–33	Station B	_____
33–43	Station C	_____
43–45	Water break	Final reset before scrimmage
45–60	Scrimmage	_____

Coach notes

What worked

What to adjust next time

Players to watch / call out (+)

Parent-facing summary

4 · Sample Session — Grades 6–8 (Week 1: Speed of Play)

Date	Wednesday, May 13, 2026 · 6:00–7:00 PM
Location	Sanborn Elementary — Lower Field, Andover
Coach(es)	Coach Shaya (lead)
Group / # players	Grades 6–8 — # players: ~12
Equipment	30 cones, 12 pinnies (3 colors), 12 balls, 2 full goals + 4 pop-ups, whistle
Theme	Speed of play & first touch under pressure

Schedule (60 min)

Time	Block	Drill
0–10	Warm-up	Rondo 4v1 / 5v2 — three grids, rotate
10–13	Water	—
13–23	Station A	Possession 4v4+2 (Neutrals)
23–33	Station B	Pressing Trigger — back pass = press
33–43	Station C	Wave Shooting (3 lines, continuous)
43–45	Water	—
45–60	Scrimmage	6v6 + neutral · 2-touch maximum in defensive third

Coach notes (sample)

What worked	Possession 4v4+2 immediately exposed who was scanning. Pressing trigger drill made the team defending concept click for the first time this season.
What to adjust	Need to enforce the 2-touch rule harder in the rondo. Wave shooting needs a 2nd ball supply to keep tempo up.
Players to watch (+)	Jake (7th) — body shape was textbook all session. Sam (6th) — finally committed defenders in 1v1.
Parent summary	We worked on speed of play tonight — scanning before receiving, first touch out of pressure, and pressing as a team. These are the habits that separate club-ready players.

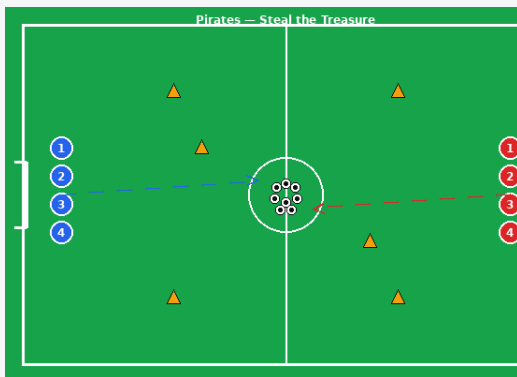
5 · Drill Library

Standardized cards with field diagrams. Every drill follows the same format — any coach can pick one up and run it. The 8 weekly fresh games appear at the end (one per K–5 week).

Core drills

PIRATES (STEAL THE TREASURE)

K–5 (great for K–2) · Dribbling at speed, ball control, fun + competition · 10–15 min · 6–20 players



Field setup

Objective

High-energy game that gets every player dribbling at speed, navigating obstacles, and protecting their ball — disguised as a pirate raid.

Setup

- Divide players into 2 teams (3 if numbers are big). Each team gets its own goal — that's their pirate ship.
- Pile ALL the soccer balls in the middle circle. That's the treasure.
- Scatter pinnies (jerseys) and/or cones randomly across the field as obstacles.
- Teams line up at their own goal, hands on the goalposts, ready to run.

How it runs

On 'GO!' every player sprints to the middle, grabs ONE ball with their feet, and dribbles it back to their own goal (their ship). Hands not allowed — feet only. Once a ball is in your goal, it's safe. Players run back for more until the middle pile is empty. Then phase 2: pirates raid the OTHER team's ship — dribble balls out of opponents' goals back to yours. When time is up (3–5 min), team with the most balls wins.

Coaching points

- Close touches — the ball stays at your feet, not 5 yards ahead
- Head up to spot obstacles and other pirates
- Use both feet to change direction around obstacles
- Shield the ball with your body when an opponent is near
- Bring it ALL the way into the goal — don't stop short

Progressions

- Add a 'guard' — 1 player per team must stay back to defend the ship
- Shrink the field or add more obstacles
- Weak-foot only round
- 3 teams instead of 2 — full chaos

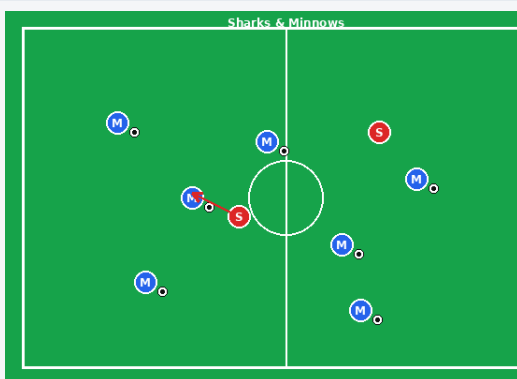
- Coach as a 'sea monster' that kicks balls back to the middle

Common mistakes

Kicking the ball ahead and chasing it (not dribbling).
Using hands when panicked. Forgetting to shield.
Standing in goal guarding instead of going back out for more treasure.

SHARKS & MINNOWS

K-5 · Dribbling, ball protection · 10 min · 6+ players



Field setup

Objective

High-energy warm-up that gets every player moving with the ball at their feet from minute one.

Setup

- 20x20 yard grid (smaller for K-1).
- Every minnow has a ball. 1-2 sharks per 8 minnows.
- Cones to mark grid corners.

How it runs

Minnows dribble inside the grid. Sharks try to kick minnow balls out. If your ball goes out, retrieve it and re-enter. Last minnow standing wins, then sharks switch.

Coaching points

- Ball close — touches every step
- Head up
- Both feet to change direction
- Shield with your body

Progressions

- Add a 2nd shark
- Shrink the grid
- Sharks must dribble too

Common mistakes

Ball too far in front → easy steal. Eyes on the ball → can't see pressure.

PARTNER PASSING — 2-TOUCH RULE

K-5 / 6-8 · First touch + passing accuracy · 10 min · Pairs players

	Objective Build a clean, repeatable rhythm of receive → pass with both feet. Setup • Pairs face each other 4–5 yards (K–5) or 7–8 yards (6–8) apart. • 1 ball per pair. • Cones optional to mark spots. How it runs Strict 2-touch: 1st touch settles in front, 2nd touch passes back. No holding. Build rhythm. After 3 min, weak foot only. Coaching points • 1st touch out of feet, into space • Inside of foot, ankle locked • Eye contact + verbal call • Both feet — alternate Progressions • Increase distance • 1-touch passing • Move while passing • Add a third moving player Common mistakes Toe-poking. First touch too heavy → has to chase the ball.
<i>Field setup</i>	

PASS & DRIVE

K–5 / 6–8 · Pass-and-move habit · 10 min · Pairs players

	Objective Eliminate standing still after a pass. Build the habit of immediately driving into space. Setup • Two pairs share a 15x10 yard channel. • Cones at each end mark target zones. • 1 ball per pair. How it runs A passes to B and drives into space. B controls and drives toward A's run, then plays the next pass. Continuous — always moving after the pass. Coaching points • Pass and move — never stand still • Drive at pace, head up • Receive on the run • Communicate the run Progressions
<i>Field setup</i>	

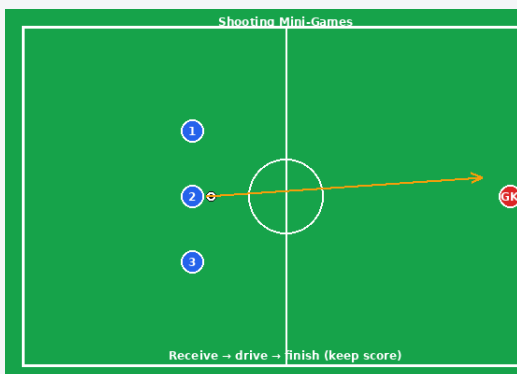
- Add a passive defender
- Add a target gate to play through
- Weak-foot drive every 3rd rep

Common mistakes

Admiring the pass — staying flat-footed. Driving too slow.

SHOOTING MINI-GAMES (DRIVE & FINISH)

K–5 / 6–8 · Finishing under controlled pressure · 10 min · 4+ per goal players



Field setup

Objective

Combine receive + drive + finish in a competitive, high-rep format.

Setup

- 1 goal + goalie (rotate). Server with ball supply 12–15 yards out.
- Line of shooters at 18 yards.
- Cones mark a 'plant foot' zone optional.

How it runs

Server plays a ball in. Shooter takes one driving touch toward goal, then finishes. Best of 5 per shooter. Rotate.

Coaching points

- First touch toward goal
- Plant foot beside ball, knee over
- Pick a corner before shooting
- Follow through

Progressions

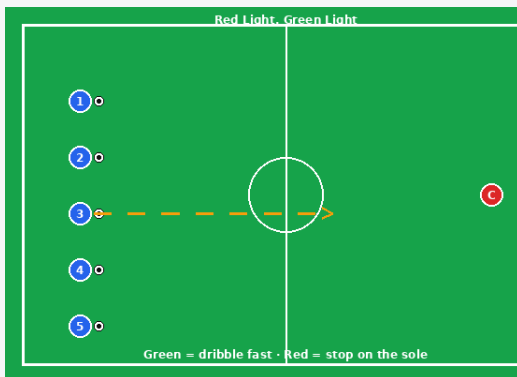
- Add a recovering defender
- 1st-time finish
- Weak-foot round

Common mistakes

Toe-poke. Plant foot too far away. Leaning back → ball flies high.

RED LIGHT, GREEN LIGHT (WITH A BALL)

K–5 (best K–2) · Close control, stop-and-go dribbling · 8–10 min · Any size players



Field setup

Objective

Teach players to dribble at speed AND stop the ball under their foot on command.

Setup

- Coach at one end line. Players line up across the opposite end line, each with a ball.
- Open field, ~25 yards.

How it runs

Coach yells 'GREEN LIGHT' — players dribble forward. 'RED LIGHT' — stop the ball under your foot instantly. Anyone with a rolling ball takes 3 steps back. First to the coach wins. 2–3 rounds.

Coaching points

- Sole stops the ball — not the toe
- Touches close on green light
- Head up to see the coach
- Both feet — alternate stopping foot

Progressions

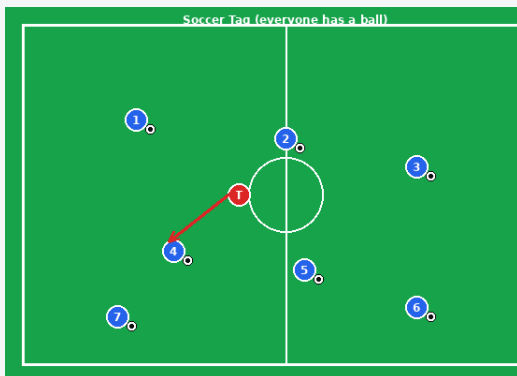
- Add 'YELLOW LIGHT' = walk slowly
- Coach turns around — only move when their back is turned
- Add a single defender for chaos

Common mistakes

Big kick on green light → can't stop in time. Stopping with the toe → ball squirts away.

SOCCER TAG (EVERYONE HAS A BALL)

K–5 · Dribbling with awareness, change of direction · 8–10 min · 8+ players



Field setup

Objective

Build the habit of dribbling with the head up — you can't dodge a tagger if you're staring at your feet.

Setup

- 20x20 yard grid. Every player has a ball.
- 1–2 taggers wear pinnies (also have a ball).

How it runs

Everyone dribbles inside the grid. Taggers try to tag other players with their hand while keeping their own ball at their feet. When tagged, swap pinnies. 4–5 minutes continuous.

Coaching points

- Eyes up — scan for taggers
- Quick change of direction with both feet
- Shield when a tagger is close
- Use the whole grid

Progressions

- Taggers must tag with their FOOT

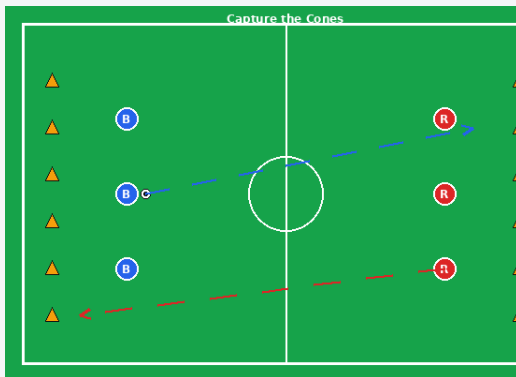
- Add a 'safe zone' cone — only 3 sec inside
- Shrink the grid

Common mistakes

Looking down → tagged immediately. Standing still in the safe zone.

CAPTURE THE CONES

K–5 · Dribbling with purpose + decision-making · 10 min · 8–16 players



Field setup

Objective

Combine dribbling, decision-making, and a tiny bit of strategy in a fast-paced team game.

Setup

- Split the field in half. Each team defends one half.
- Place 5 cones on each end line (the 'treasure').
- Every player has a ball. Pinnies for one team.

How it runs

Players dribble across midfield, knock down a cone with their ball, dribble back. If tagged in the opponent's half, you freeze with your ball until a teammate dribbles past to free you. Most cones in 5 min wins.

Coaching points

- Look up before crossing midfield
- Dribble fast to and from the cone
- Help frozen teammates
- Communicate which cone you're going for

Progressions

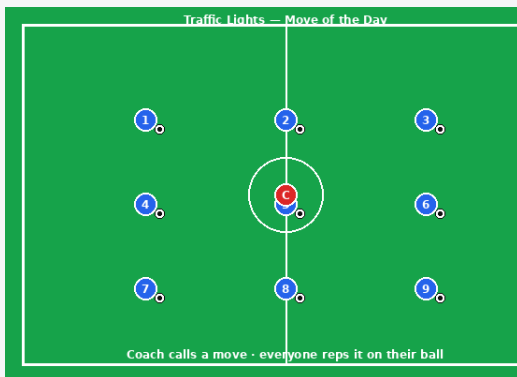
- Defenders can win the BALL (foot tag)
- Add neutral zones where you can't be tagged
- 3v3 on a smaller field

Common mistakes

Everyone goes for the same cone. Forgetting to free teammates. Slow dribble back.

TRAFFIC LIGHTS (MOVE-OF-THE-DAY)

K–5 · Foundational moves, both feet, listening skills · 5–8 min · Any size players



Field setup

Objective

Introduce and rep a specific dribbling move every session — builds a vocabulary over the season.

Setup

- Players spread out in a 20x20 grid, each with a ball.
- Coach in the middle calling commands.

How it runs

Coach calls a command, every player does it on their ball: 'Toe taps', 'Sole rolls', 'Pull-back', 'L-turn'. Add the 'move of the day' — one new move per session that rotates.

Coaching points

- Both feet every move
- Quality over speed at first
- Stay on your toes
- Coach demos every new move first

Progressions

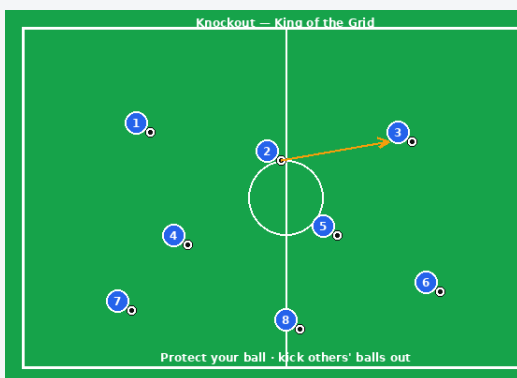
- String 2 moves together
- Coach calls moves faster
- Free play — kids invent moves

Common mistakes

Only using dominant foot. Sloppy reps. Standing still between commands.

KNOCKOUT (KING OF THE GRID)

K–5 / 6–8 · 1v1 ball protection, shielding · 8–10 min · 6–14 players



Field setup

Objective

Develop ball protection, shielding, and 1v1 awareness in a competitive last-player-standing format.

Setup

- 15x15 yard grid (smaller for fewer players).
- Every player has a ball inside the grid.

How it runs

All players dribble inside the grid. Each tries to keep their own ball under control while kicking OTHER players' balls out. If your ball goes out, you're out — do 5 toe taps and wait. Last player wins.

Coaching points

- Eyes up — protect yours, attack theirs
- Shield with body when closed in
- Pick targets — go after distracted kids
- Keep your ball moving

Progressions

- Shrink the grid as players are knocked out
- 'Champions round' for last 3

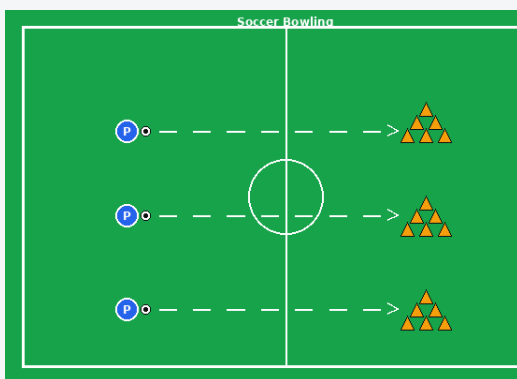
- Team version: last team with any ball wins

Common mistakes

Chasing other balls and forgetting your own. Stopping to shield instead of moving while shielding.

SOCCER BOWLING

K–5 (great K–2) · Passing accuracy, weight of pass · 8–10 min · Pairs or small groups players



Field setup

Objective

Make passing accuracy the OBJECT of the game so kids care about technique without being told to.

Setup

- Pyramids of 3–6 cones (the 'pins') 8–12 yards from a passing line.
- 1 ball per player. Multiple stations if numbers are big.

How it runs

Players take turns passing at the cone pyramid. Score 1 point per cone knocked down. After 5 turns, count it up. Reset, run another round with weak foot.

Coaching points

- Plant foot beside the ball, pointed at the target
- Inside of foot, ankle locked
- Weight of pass matters
- Follow through toward the target

Progressions

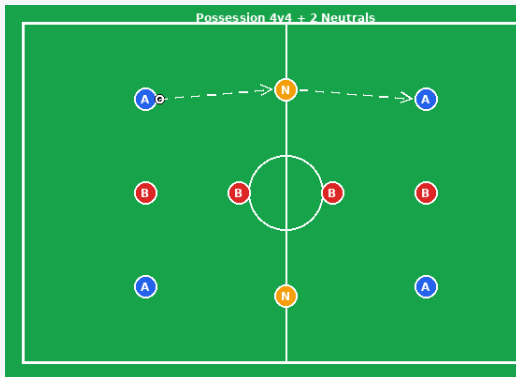
- Move pyramid further away
- Weak foot round
- Moving target — partner rolls a ball, hit before it stops
- 1-touch from a pass

Common mistakes

Toe-poking. Plant foot pointing wrong direction. Trying to blast it instead of placing it.

POSSESSION 4V4+2 (NEUTRALS)

6–8 · Possession, support angles, decision speed · 10–12 min · 10 players



Field setup

Objective

Train keeping the ball under pressure with numerical advantage created by neutral support players.

Setup

- 25x20 yard grid.
- Two teams of 4 + 2 neutrals (3rd color) who play for whoever has the ball.
- 1 ball.

How it runs

Possession game: team with ball + 2 neutrals = 6v4. 8 consecutive passes = 1 point. If defenders win, possession flips and neutrals join the new attacking team. 4-min rounds, rotate neutrals.

Coaching points

- Body shape open — half-turned to see two options
- Use neutrals as outlets when pressured
- First touch out of pressure, second touch is the pass
- Off-ball: provide an angle, not a straight line

Progressions

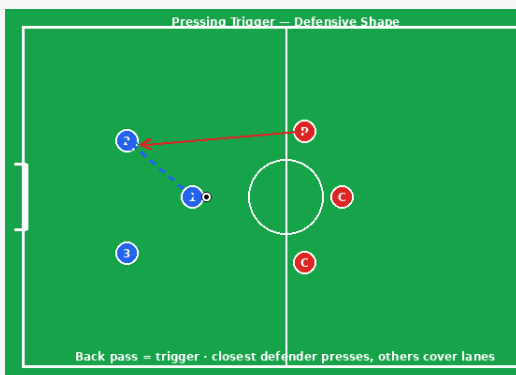
- 2-touch maximum
- 1-touch only for neutrals
- 'Split pass' bonus = 2 points
- Reduce to 4v4+1

Common mistakes

Standing flat / square to the passer. Hiding behind defenders. Slow first touch.

PRESSING TRIGGER (DEFENSIVE SHAPE)

6–8 · Team defending, pressing as a unit · 10–12 min · 8–12 players



Back pass = trigger · closest defender presses, others cover lanes

Field setup

Objective

Teach when to press as a team — not random chasing, but coordinated pressure on a trigger.

Setup

- Half a small-sided field with two small goals on each end line.
- Two teams of 4–6. Pinnies.
- Coach designates a 'trigger' (e.g., back pass, sloppy first touch).

How it runs

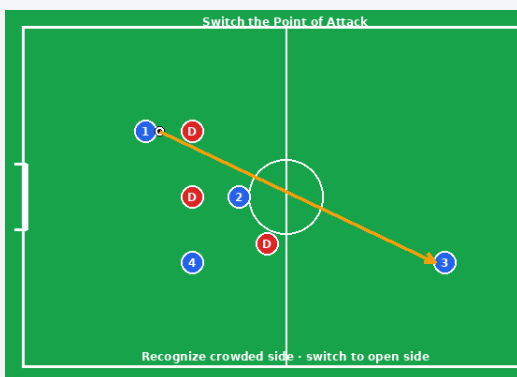
Possession game with goals. Defending team stays compact mid-block UNTIL the trigger fires. Then closest player presses, next two cover lanes, rest squeeze the field. Win ball within 6 sec = 2 points. Concede goal = 1 point to the other team.

Coaching points

	• Press the BALL, cover the LANES — not both at once • First defender steps with intent, doesn't dive in • Communicate: 'PRESS!' when trigger fires • Compact shape — squeeze gaps Progressions • Add a second trigger • Reduce press window to 4 sec • Add a goalkeeper to extend buildup Common mistakes Whole team chases the ball. Pressing too late. Pressing without compact shape behind.
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SWITCH THE POINT OF ATTACK

6–8 · Long passing, scanning, switching play · 10–12 min · 8–10 players



Field setup

Objective

Teach players to recognize when one side is overloaded and move the ball to the open side.

Setup

- Full small-sided field divided into two channels (left half and right half).
- Two teams. Two small goals on each end line.
- 1 ball. Pinnies.

How it runs

Possession with goals, but a goal only counts after the ball has traveled from one channel to the other in the buildup (a 'switch'). Players must recognize when their channel is crowded and switch — long pass, dribble across, or short passes.

Coaching points

- Scan the far side BEFORE receiving
- Body open to the field, not square
- Quality switch pass — firm, in front of receiver
- Receiver on the far side: stay wide, stay high

Progressions

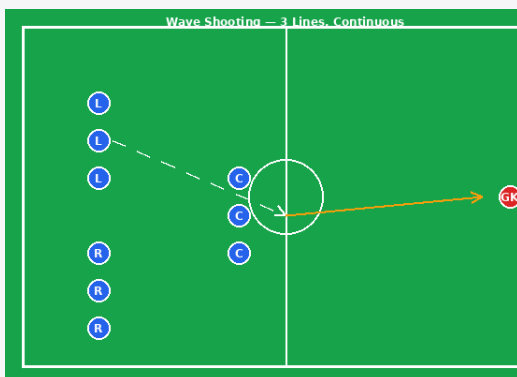
- Switch in 3 passes or fewer
- Add positive touch forward after the switch
- Add a third channel

Common mistakes

Everyone runs to the ball side. Switch pass too soft → intercepted. Receiver flat-footed.

WAVE SHOOTING (3 LINES, CONTINUOUS)

6–8 · Finishing technique, repetition under fatigue · 10–12 min · 9+ players



Field setup

Objective

High-rep finishing in a structured wave format — every player gets 6–8 quality strikes in 10 min.

Setup

- 1 goal + goalie (rotate every 2 min).
- 3 lines: wide left at 20y, central at 25y, wide right at 20y.
- Ball supply with each line.

How it runs

Wave 1 (left): dribble to corner of box, cross; central runs and finishes. Wave 2 (right): mirror. Wave 3 (central): dribble in 1v1 vs goalie. Continuous rotation for 10 min.

Coaching points

- Crosser: head up, look for the run, drive across face of goal
- Finisher: time the run late, not early
- First touch toward goal
- Plant foot beside ball, knee over, follow through

Progressions

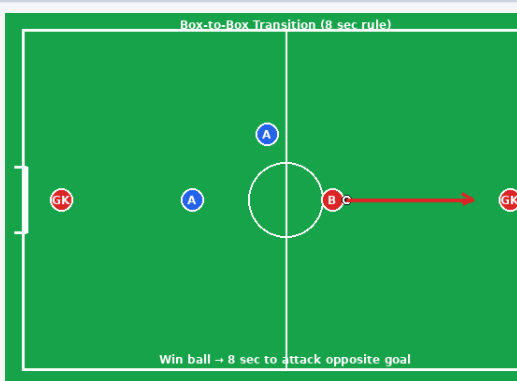
- Add a recovering defender on the finisher
- 1-touch finish only
- Weak-foot round
- Add a 2nd finisher for 2v1 in the box

Common mistakes

Crossing into the goalie's hands. Finisher arrives early and stops. Toe-poke instead of clean strike.

BOX-TO-BOX TRANSITION

6–8 · Transition speed (defense → attack) · 10–12 min · 10–12 players



Field setup

Objective

Train the moment after winning the ball — speed of decision and break-out is what separates good teams.

Setup

- Full small-sided field with two real goals + goalies.
- Two teams of 4–5. Pinnies.
- Coach with extra balls at midfield.

How it runs

Game in one half — Team A attacks Team B's goal. Moment Team B wins the ball OR ball goes out, they have 8 seconds to attack the OTHER goal. Coach counts down. No shot in 8 sec = possession flips back.

Coaching points

- First pass after winning the ball is most important — make it forward
- Off-ball runs IMMEDIATELY on turnover

- Decision speed: shoot, drive, or release the runner
- Keep shape — don't all sprint forward

Progressions

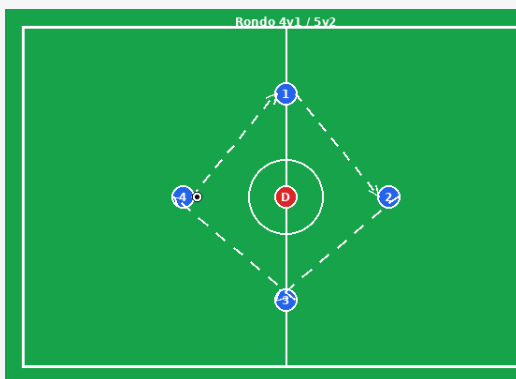
- Reduce window to 6 sec
- 'Must combine' rule — 2 passes before shooting
- Add a recovering defender from team that just lost it

Common mistakes

Slow first pass after winning. Everyone runs forward — no balance. Trying to dribble through pressure.

RONDO 4V1 / 5V2

6–8 · Possession under pressure, body shape · 10 min · 5–7 players



Field setup

Objective

Develop scanning, body shape, and quick decisions in tight space.

Setup

- 8x8 yard grid (4v1) or 10x10 (5v2).
- Outside players keep possession; defender(s) inside try to win it.
- 1 ball, pinnies for defenders.

How it runs

2-touch max. If defender wins or ball goes out, the player who lost it switches in. Add 1-touch rule after 3 min.

Coaching points

- Open body shape — half-turned to see two options
- Scan before the ball arrives
- First touch out of pressure
- Support angles — never hide behind the defender

Progressions

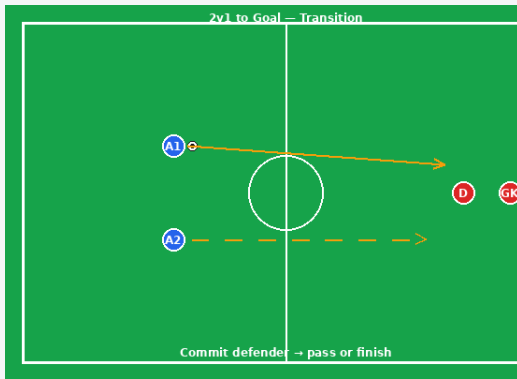
- 1-touch only
- Add a 2nd defender
- 'Split pass' bonus point through the defender

Common mistakes

Standing flat. Slow first touch. No scanning.

2V1 TO GOAL (TRANSITION)

6–8 · Decision-making in attack · 10 min · 6+ players



Field setup

Objective

Force quick attacking decisions: shoot, pass, or dribble.

Setup

- Half a small-sided field. 1 goal + goalie.
- Coach with ball supply at midfield.
- 2 attackers + 1 defender start at midfield.

How it runs

Coach plays a ball forward — 2v1 attack the goal. 30 sec max per rep. Reset and rotate. Keep score by team.

Coaching points

- Attacker on the ball: commit the defender
- Off-ball attacker: stay wide, late run for the slot
- Pass when defender steps to you, dribble when they back off
- Always end with a shot or clear miss

Progressions

- Add a recovering 2nd defender after 3 sec
- Must combine before scoring
- Switch to 3v2

Common mistakes

Two attackers stacked vertically. Pass too early without committing the defender.

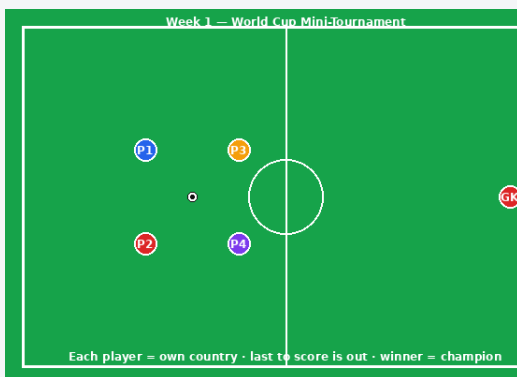
Weekly Fresh Games (K–5) — one new game per week

These 8 games rotate through the K–5 season — one featured per week to keep things fresh.

Week 1 featured game

WORLD CUP MINI-TOURNAMENT

K–5 · Fun, individual battles, finishing · 10–12 min · 4–8 per goal players



Field setup

Objective

Light-hearted free-for-all to start the season — every kid is their own 'country' and competes individually.

Setup

- 1 goal + GK (rotate).
- All players are individuals (not on teams) — each picks a country.
- Coach with ball supply.

How it runs

Coach throws a ball into the area. Free-for-all: every player tries to score. First to score is safe and steps out. Round continues until 1 player is left — that player is OUT for the tournament. Reset, repeat. Last player remaining wins the World Cup.

Coaching points

- Hustle to the ball
- First touch toward goal
- Don't quit — losers come back next round if they're not last
- Have fun yelling country names

Progressions

- Eliminate 2 per round (faster)
- Teams of 2 (each 'country' has 2 players)
- Add a 'bonus' goal at the back

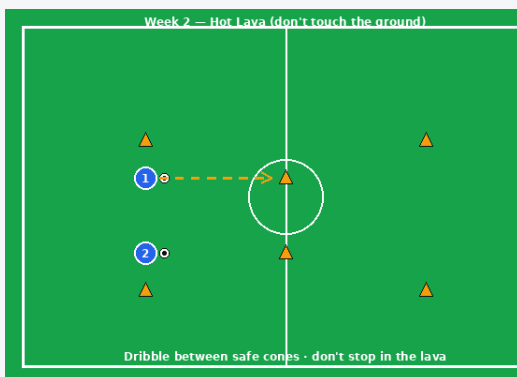
Common mistakes

Standing back waiting. Toe-poking instead of striking.

Week 2 featured game

HOT LAVA

K–5 · First touch + dribbling between obstacles · 8–10 min · Any size players



Field setup

Objective

Make first touch the point of the game — wherever you stop the ball must be on a 'safe island'.

Setup

- Scatter cones / pinnies / small flat markers across a 25x25 grid as 'safe islands'.
- Every player has a ball.
- The rest of the grid is HOT LAVA.

How it runs

Players dribble continuously. Coach yells 'STOP!' — every player must stop their ball ON a safe cone (close enough to touch). Anyone whose ball is in the lava (between cones) does 5 jumping jacks. Reset, repeat with shorter intervals.

Coaching points

- Plan ahead — eyes up to spot the next island
- Soft first touch onto the cone, not past it
- Both feet to control
- Don't bunch up at the same cone

Progressions

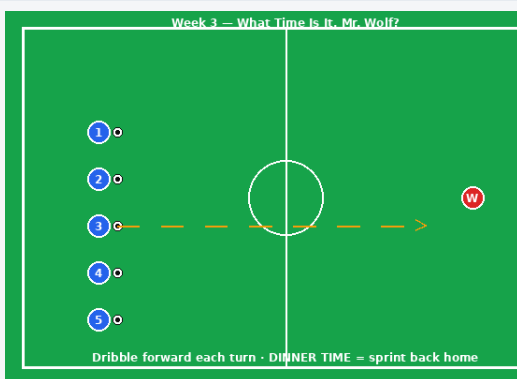
- Remove cones each round
- Add a 'shark' that pushes balls into the lava
- Pairs share a ball

Common mistakes

Heavy touch flies over the cone. Not looking up — picks the same cone as someone else.

Week 3 featured game**WHAT TIME IS IT, MR. WOLF?**

K–5 (best K–2) · Pass accuracy + sprint with the ball · 8–10 min · Any size players



Field setup

Objective

Classic playground game with a soccer twist — players take dribbling 'steps' forward, and at 'DINNER TIME' they sprint back.

Setup

- Coach (the 'wolf') stands at one end with their back to players.
- Players line up at the opposite end, each with a ball, ~25 yards away.

How it runs

Players shout 'WHAT TIME IS IT, MR WOLF?' Coach answers '3 O'CLOCK' — every player takes 3 dribbling touches forward. Continue. When coach yells 'DINNER TIME!' coach turns and chases — players sprint back to home with their ball. Anyone tagged becomes the next wolf.

Coaching points

- Quality of touches — not big kicks
- Both feet — alternate left/right
- Eyes up at all times to watch the wolf
- Sprint with the ball, don't abandon it

Progressions

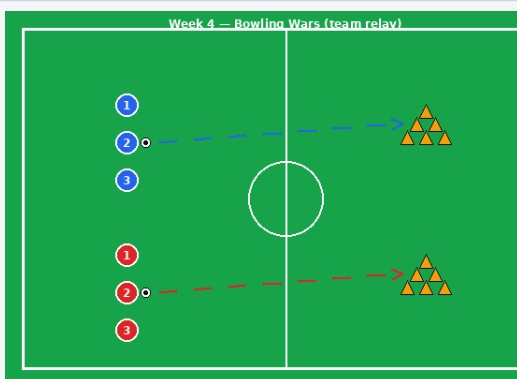
- Wolf moves while their back is turned
- Add a 2nd wolf
- Wolf can call '12 O'CLOCK' = take 12 touches forward

Common mistakes

Big touches that send the ball past 3 steps. Abandoning the ball when running back.

Week 4 featured game**BOWLING WARS (TEAM RELAY)**

K–5 · Passing accuracy under pressure + teamwork · 10–12 min · 8–14 (2 teams) players



Field setup

Objective

Take soccer bowling and add team competition + relay format — kids care about accuracy because their teammates are waiting.

Setup

- Two pyramids of 6 cones — one for each team — set 12 yards from a passing line.
- Teams in single-file lines at the passing line.
- 1 ball per team (plus extras).

How it runs

First player passes at their pyramid, retrieves the ball, dribbles it back, hands off to the next player. Continue for 4 minutes. Team that knocks down the most total cones wins. Reset cones if a pyramid is fully knocked down — each reset = 1 bonus point.

Coaching points

- Plant foot pointed at the pyramid
- Inside of foot, weight matters
- Don't waste retrieval — quick dribble back
- Cheer for teammates — momentum matters

Progressions

- Weak foot only
- Move pyramid to 18 yards
- Moving pyramid (coach slowly walks the cones)
- Pass from a 1-touch (someone rolls a ball, you strike)

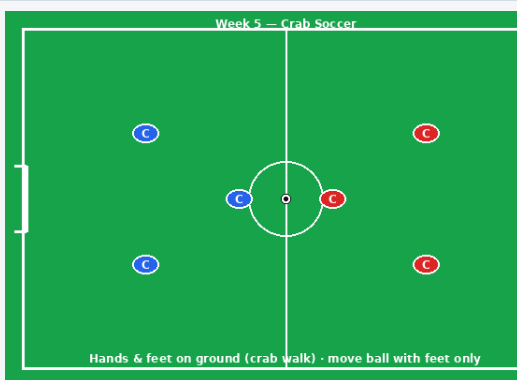
Common mistakes

Toe-poking from rushing. Slow retrieval kills the relay. Standing still while waiting in line — keep doing toe taps.

Week 5 featured game

CRAB SOCCER

K–5 (perfect K–2) · Body coordination, fun, laughter · 8–10 min · 6–12 players



Field setup

Objective

Pure fun + body coordination — playing soccer in 'crab walk' position. Builds core strength without them realizing.

Setup

- Small field with 2 small goals.
- 2 teams.
- 1 ball — slightly deflated is best (rolls slower).

How it runs

Every player **MUST** move in crab walk position (hands and feet on ground, belly up). Use feet to play the ball. No standing up. No goalies. First team to 5 goals wins, then reset.

Coaching points

- Stay in crab position — coach calls 'CRAB!' if anyone stands
- Use both feet to play the ball
- Communicate with teammates
- It's about fun — laugh!

Progressions

- Add a goalie (also in crab position)
- Bigger field
- Use a heavier/lighter ball
- Teams must complete 3 passes before scoring

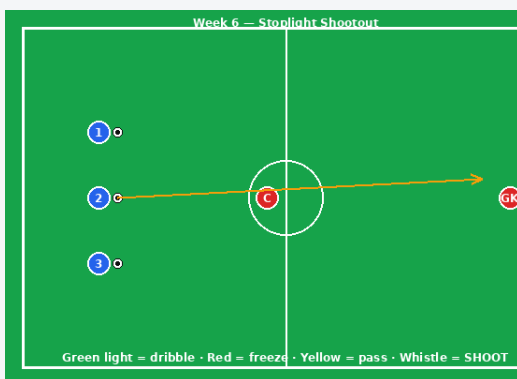
Common mistakes

Standing up when frustrated. Bunching around the ball. Forgetting to actually play soccer (just laughing — which is fine occasionally!)

Week 6 featured game

STOPLIGHT SHOOTOUT

K–5 · Listening + decision-making + finishing · 10 min · 6–10 players

**Objective**

Combine the listening focus from Red Light Green Light with shooting — players must react to coach's color call.

Setup

- 1 goal + GK.
- Players line up 25 yards out, each with a ball.
- Coach stands midway between line and goal.

How it runs

On 'GREEN' all players dribble forward. 'YELLOW' = pass to a teammate (any direction). 'RED' = freeze. WHISTLE = whoever has the ball nearest the goal **SHOOTS** —

Field setup

everyone else watches. Reset and repeat for ~10 min, keeping a tally of goals.

Coaching points

- Listen for the call — react fast
- On YELLOW: accurate, weighted pass to a teammate
- On WHISTLE: first touch toward goal, then strike
- Don't argue who shoots — coach decides

Progressions

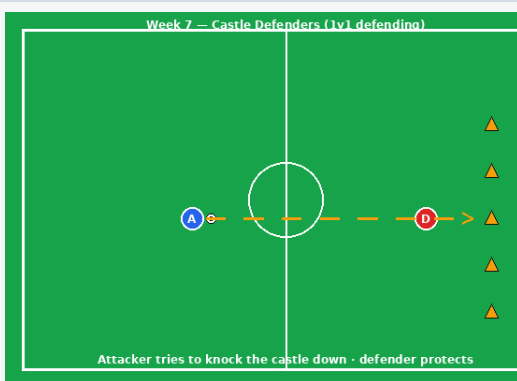
- Add a defender between line and goal
- 2 colors at once ('GREEN' + dribbling move)
- Teams (one team's player shoots per round)

Common mistakes

Players panic on YELLOW and pass to no one. Arguing over who's closest on whistle.

Week 7 featured game**CASTLE DEFENDERS (1v1)**

K–5 · 1v1 defending + 1v1 attacking · 10–12 min · 6+ players

*Field setup***Objective**

Make 1v1 defending the GAME — defender protects the 'castle' (line of cones), attacker tries to knock it down.

Setup

- Stack 5 cones on a line as the 'castle' (3 cones high at the top of a 'D' if you can).
- Defender starts in front of the castle (~5 yards away).
- Attacker starts 20 yards out with a ball.

How it runs

Attacker tries to knock the castle down by passing or dribbling at it. Defender defends — must stay on their feet, no slide tackles. 30 seconds per rep. If attacker scores (knocks any cone), they switch to defending. Otherwise rotate after 30 sec.

Coaching points

- Defender: low body, side-on, patient — don't dive in
- Defender: force the attacker wide, away from the castle
- Attacker: commit the defender, then go around or shoot
- No slide tackles — work on staying on your feet

Progressions

- 2v1 (attackers have a 2-on-1 advantage)
- 2v2
- Smaller castle (1 cone)

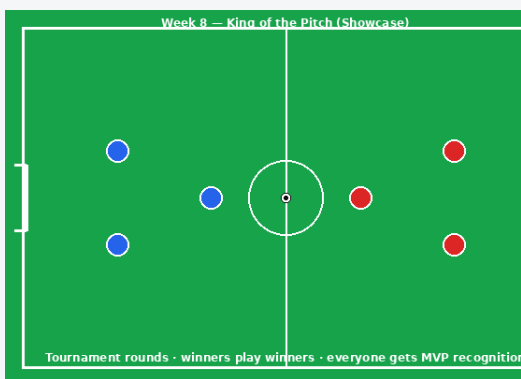
- Defender starts further back

Common mistakes

Defender dives in / lunges. Defender turns sideways and gets beat behind. Attacker shoots from too far without committing the defender.

Week 8 featured game**KING OF THE PITCH (SHOWCASE)**

K–5 · Apply everything · celebrate growth · 20–25 (full session) min · All players



Field setup

Objective

Season-end mini-tournament. Every player demonstrates what they've learned in real game situations.

Setup

- 2 (or 3) small-sided fields with goals.
- Split into 3–4 small teams of 3–4 players.
- Coach has a bracket / scorecard.

How it runs

Round 1: each team plays each other team for 4 minutes. Track wins and goals scored. Top 2 teams play in a final; remaining teams play a consolation. Coach awards individual MVPs at the end: 'Best Dribbler', 'Most Improved', 'Best Teammate', 'Best Defender' — every kid gets recognition.

Coaching points

- Apply the season's themes: ball mastery, first touch, pass & move, finishing
- Communicate — call for the ball
- Help teammates — pass, don't hog
- Have fun — this is the celebration

Progressions

- Add neutral player who plays for whoever has the ball
- Coach-imposed constraints per round (e.g., 'must pass before shooting')
- Free play final 5 min

Common mistakes

Star players hog the ball — coach intervenes. Quiet players hide — coach assigns them roles.

6 · Weekly Skill Plan — K–5 (8 weeks)

Each week pairs a technical theme with a featured fresh game.

W k	Theme	Why	Station ideas (pick 3)	Featured fresh game	Scrimmage rule
1	Ball mastery & comfort	Confidence with ball at feet. Joy tone for the season.	Sharks & Minnows · Pirates · Traffic Lights	World Cup Mini-Tournament	Free play. Coach observes only.
2	First touch (settle the ball)	Foundation of every other skill.	Partner Passing 2-touch · Wall passing · Throw-and-trap	Hot Lava	Goals only count after a clean first touch.
3	Passing accuracy (inside of foot)	Core technique. Build before adding speed.	Partner Passing (longer) · Pass to gate · Triangle passing	What Time Is It, Mr. Wolf?	3 passes before a shot.
4	Pass & move	Break the standing-still-after-pass habit.	Pass & Drive · Give-and-go · Triangle rotation	Bowling Wars (Team Relay)	After a pass, touch a different cone before receiving again.
5	Dribbling with purpose (change of direction)	Dribbling = beating an opponent or escaping pressure.	Cone slalom · 1v1 to a line · Pirates (obstacle-heavy)	Crab Soccer	Successful 1v1 dribble = 1 bonus point.
6	Shooting (plant foot, follow through)	Teach 'strike' not 'kick' before habits set.	Shooting Mini-Games · Stationary strike · Dribble & finish	Stoplight Shootout	Shots from outside the box = 2 points.
7	Defending basics (stance & patience)	Defending = patience, not tackling.	1v1 defending · Shadow defending · 2v2 to small goals	Castle Defenders	Clean tackle by defender = 1 point for defending team.
8	Putting it all together (Showcase)	Apply everything · celebrate growth.	Free choice · Skills challenges · Tournament rounds	King of the Pitch (Showcase)	Tournament. Every player gets MVP recognition for one specific skill.

7 · Weekly Skill Plan — Grades 6–8 (8 weeks)

Faster pace, structured tactical progression.

W k	Theme	Why	Station ideas (pick 3)	Scrimmage rule
1	Speed of play & first touch under pressure	Game speeds up at this age — first touch must be intentional.	Rondo 4v1 · Receive under pressure · 1-touch wall pass	2-touch maximum in defensive third.
2	Body shape & scanning	Players who scan see twice as many options.	Rondo 5v2 · Color-call game · Half-turn receive	Coach calls 'scan!' randomly — players shout what they see behind them.
3	Combination play (1-2s, overlaps)	Two players combining beat one good defender.	Pass & Drive variants · Overlap pattern · 3-man weave to finish	Combination goal = double points.
4	Finishing in transition	Most goals come from transition moments.	2v1 to Goal · Counter from GK throw · Wave Shooting (1-touch)	First shot must come within 6 sec of winning the ball.
5	Defending — pressure, cover, balance	Group defending separates real teams from rec teams.	1v1 angles · 2v2 with recovering defender · Pressing Trigger	Team defends as a unit — out-of-position defender = free shot.
6	Switching the point of attack	Good teams move the ball side to side.	Long-pass accuracy · Switch-of-play rondo · Possession to wide targets	Switched-side goal = double points.
7	1v1 attacking (commit & beat)	Confidence to take a defender on is learned.	1v1 to goal · Move-of-the-week · 1v1 to two end-line gates	Successful 1v1 dribble = 1 bonus team point.
8	Showcase — game model	Apply themes in a full tournament.	Tactical walkthrough · 6v6 tournament · Skills challenge	Tournament. Players self-select positions.

End of playbook. To update: edit inline in Google Docs, OR ask Claude to add/change drills and regenerate.